

General Lit





About the Course

Students spend extended time with a 19th century novel and personal narrative and will find rich opportunities for discussion and inspiration.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grades 7-8



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for Grades 9-10. Due to more challenging content, we do not advise using these lessons with younger students if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	General Lit: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	Little Women Sir Gibbie Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 7-8				
General Lit: Grades 7-8				Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

General Lit: Grades 7-8

☐ My Brother Sam is Dead (Term 2) is a riveting and complex story about the American Revolution. We recommend previewing this book to decide if you want to discuss or give your students a heads up about some instances of language and intense scenes.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit: Grades 7-8



Little Women



Sir Gibbie



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



General Lit: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or

challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.

- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, legos, dolls, etc. to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time, can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

General Lit: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1	
WEEK 1	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1
WEEK 2	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2
WEEK 3	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3
WEEK 4	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4
WEEK 5	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5
WEEK 6	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6
WEEK 7	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7
WEEK 8	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8
WEEK 9	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9
WEEK 10	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10
WEEK 11	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11
WEEK 12	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

General Lit: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2	
WEEK 1	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13
WEEK 2	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14
WEEK 3	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15
WEEK 4	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16
WEEK 5	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17
WEEK 6	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18
WEEK 7	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19
WEEK 8	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20
WEEK 9	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21
WEEK 10	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22
WEEK 11	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23
WEEK 12	30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

General Lit: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p1-7 "I was born in Tuckahoe" - "a good overseer" [omit the more violent passages for this age?]

- What do we learn about Frederick Douglass's family in this opening reading? What initial impressions do you have of his narrative style? How might this be connected to his aims for this autobiography? Consider in particular how he describes the more difficult and violent episodes from his childhood.

→ **PROMPT**
∞

WEEK 2 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **RECAP**

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.7-13 "The home plantation" - "stone-like coolness."

- Reflect on Douglass's descriptions of the slave's songs. What purposes does singing serve? How has it been misunderstood?

→ **PROMPT**
∞

WEEK 3 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.13-19 "His savage barbarity" - "voice of tranquil music." [omit first paragraph?]

- Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**
∞

WEEK 4 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

General Lit: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

p.19-26 "But alas!" - "learning how to write."

- Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**

∞

WEEK 5 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.26-33 "In a very short time" - "sagacity to see it."

- Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**

∞

WEEK 6 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.33-39 "While I lived with my master" - "myself to my wretched lot."

- Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**

∞

WEEK 7 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.39-45 "I have already intimated" - "practice is a very common one."

- Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**

∞

WEEK 8 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from last week's reading?



Term 3	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.45-52 "On the first of January" - "we succeeded very well." • Discussion Question Idea → PROMPT ∞	
WEEK 9 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33 <i>Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass</i> Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass → RECAP What do you recall from last week's reading? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.52-58 "After a painful waiting" - "Christian city of Baltimore." • Discussion Question Idea → PROMPT ∞	
WEEK 10 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34 <i>Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass</i> Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass → RECAP What do you recall from last week's reading? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p. • Discussion Question Idea → PROMPT ∞	
WEEK 11 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36	

General Lit: Grades 7-8

Examination

- Term 1** · Little Women: Pilgrim's Progress is referred to multiple times in the book. Explain Jo's Apollyon in Ch.8, Meg's Vanity Fair in Ch.9, or discuss other parallels to Pilgrim's Progress that you've seen.
- Term 2** · Act out OR write a scene from Little Women as a play.